FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-28-21001

Issue Title : 737 APU Fuel Line Shroud Damaged Found Due To Electrical Wire Clamp Bolt

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2825-05	-8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
737NG	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
08/09/2021	02/01/2024	01/24/2024
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

The Milestones section was updated. This article is now closed.

Applicability

All 737 MAX airplanes prior to Line Number (LN) 6791.

Description

Multiple 737 operators have experienced damage to the Auxiliary Power Unit (APU) Fuel Line Shroud, Part Number (PN) 346A2201-20, caused by a non-conforming installation of a wire clamp and fastener (refer to the attachment in this article). The clamp is attached to the water tank overflow line, which secures the S692 water pressure switch wire. An incorrect installation of the clamp and fastener may cause a chafing condition, and can eventually puncture the APU Fuel Line Shroud. This condition will require corrective action during the service life of the airplanes affected.

Background

The APU fuel feed hose is encased by a shroud that protects for fuel leaks coming from the hose. The shroud runs from the center fuel tank to the APU in the aft section of the airplane. The shroud provides a drainage path for fuel to be vented overboard via the APU drain mast. Acting as a secondary barrier of protection from an inner fuel hose leak, the shroud prevents fuel from entering the pressurized area of the aircraft.

A portion of the shroud is located above the water tank overflow line. The water tank has a pressure switch that is located on top of the tank, and the connecting pressure switch wire is clamped to the water tank overflow line via a clamp and a fastener. The clamp and fastener may be oriented incorrectly, and may make contact with the shroud over time.

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The non-conforming installation of this clamp has caused damage to the APU Fuel Line Shroud. If the shroud is damaged, a sequential failure of the APU fuel feed hose could result in a flammable fluid leak in an ignition zone. This flammable fluid has the potential to lead to an undetected and unsuppressed fire event behind the cargo liner in the aft cargo bay. This non-conforming condition is suspected to be present on 737 NG and MAX line numbers 1 – 6790. To date, there have been multiple reports of shroud damage and no reports of APU fuel feed hose, resulting from this condition.

Initial operator reports indicated damage was located on the PN 346A2201-20 shroud. However, the PN of the shroud installed is dependent on the airplane's build configuration. Please refer to the table attached in this Fleet Team Digest.

Status

Boeing has reevaluated the chafing condition and has determined that a Service Bulletin (SB) is required to rectify the condition. Service Letter (SL) 737-SL-28-125 is superseded by the Boeing Alert SB 737-38A1073.The Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) has released Airworthiness Directive (AD) 2023-04-17, with an effective date of May 1, 2023. The AD requires implementation of the Boeing Alert SB 737-38A1073, with a 3-year compliance time.

Boeing has received reports of installations without the datum wiring clamp. Boeing will update the SB to provide instructions that account for a missing wiring clamp.

Additionally, Boeing is evaluating an APU fuel line shroud on-wing repair that could be performed as an alternate to CMM 28-00-10 repair options. The repair would entail fabricating and installing an aluminum doubler to wrap around the damaged portion of the shroud. See 737MAX-FTD-28-22003 for additional information for on-wing repair.

Interim Action

If operators find damage to the APU fuel feed line shroud, refer to AMM 28-22-15-700-801 to disposition tube damage. Ensure the clamp located near the water pressure cutout switch S692 (immediately aft of Station 947.5) is installed per drawing 288A4747.

The SB instructs operators to ensure a prescribed amount of clearance exists between the APU fuel feed line shroud and the clamp's fastener. Note that since SL 737-SL-28-125 is not a formal FAA document, this SL is not a means of compliance for the AD.

Final Action

Boeing production installation drawings were revised to highlight the correct installation of the water tank pressure switch wire clamp and fastener away from the APU Fuel Line Shroud. The clarification was annotated as a note on production drawings. All 737NG and MAX airplanes from line number 6791 and on were built to the updated installation drawing.

For affected airplanes, the final operator action is to implement SB 737-38A1072. This SB gives instructions: 1) to inspect the APU fuel line shroud for damage, 2) to inspect the pressure switch wire clamp for correct bolt orientation and horizontal distance

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from the APU fuel line shroud, and 3) to carry out the corrective actions as applicable.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Production Incorporation - Drawing Clarification: Jan 2018 (complete)

Service Letter: 737-SL-28-125-A, Jul 2021 (complete)

Spare Parts Support - APU Fuel Shroud

- PN 346A2201-20: Jul-2021 (complete)
- All other PN's 346A2201-XX: Dec-2021 (complete)

Spare Parts Support - APU Fuel Feed Hoses (All PN's): May-2022 (complete)

Service Bulletins:

- 737-38A1073, R1, revised for Missing Clamp, MAX: 19-Jan-2024 (complete)

FAA Airworthiness Directive:

2023-04-17, Effective Date of May 1, 2023 with a 3-year compliance time

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-38A1073		
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-28-125-A		
Other	ISS-38-21-36249		
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737MAX-FTD-28-22001		
Service Related Problem (SRP)	737NG-SRP-28-0230		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
APU Shroud Fuel Line	346A2201-19	Boeing	346A2201-19
Fuel Hose	B920-50	Parker	B920-50
APU Shroud Fuel Line	346A2201-3	Boeing	346A2201-3
APU Shroud Fuel Line	346A2201-11	Boeing	346A2201-11

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APU Shroud Fuel Line	346A2201-20	Boeing	346A2201-20
APU Shroud Fuel Line	346A2201-26	Boeing	346A2201-26
APU Shroud Fuel Line	346A2201-27	Boeing	346A2201-27
Fuel Hose	B920-53	Parker	B920-53
Fuel Hose	B920-58	Parker	B920-58
Fuel Hose	B920EEE5420D	Parker	B920EEE5420D
Fuel Hose	B920EEE6540D	Parker	B920EEE6540D

Related Categories

- SRPs - Safety : Service Related Problems in work by Boeing that have an airplane or personal safety impact

Attachments:

a) APU Fuel Feed and Shroud Part Numbers

b) APU Shroud Damge Photo's

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